

THE GROWING **POPULARITY OF eSPORTS** AMIDST COVID-19 PANDEMIC

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The global outbreak of Covid-19 pandemic has changed the dynamics of games in the sports sector. Most live sports across the world have been cancelled, or postponed with no exact information on new dates. This has not only affected the sports industry but also sports lovers. Due to this current situation, sports lovers have now turned to esports, or

electronic sports, for their entertainment.

Streaming of both competitive and casual games has become a rising trend in esports. Most of the major eSports tournaments/events, including PUBG Mobile World League, Overwatch League, ESL Pro League, have switched their operation completely online. Esports has gained a lot of traction, and a significant surge of adoption has been witnessed by stay-at-home fans and quarantine culture.

Notably, esports is one of the fastest-growing industries and a booming market in the world. As per a report by research firm Newzoo, esports sector is expected to generate 1.79 billion dollars per year by 2022. India is also picking up in the international league of esports and has become one of the most potential markets from a growth perspective. Many startups have ventured into esports, such as INRacing, PokerDangal, NODWIN Gaming, and 99Games.